

A Burmistrov combination

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Burmistrov is a variation of Le Grand where in one phase white threatens two mates and a thematic black defence is met by a third mate. In next two phases this third mate is a threat and black's thematic defence is once met by one and once by the other mate which were threats in the first phase. The problem for study below is a Burmistrov which won Gold medal in FIDE World Cup 2025

1st Prize by Petr Gvozdzjak
FIDE World Cup 2025



Mate in two moves

The judge Marco Guida observes- "A rare Burmistrov Combination with 4 thematic mates (3× Le Grand with a multiple-threat introductory try) and a fourfold Makihovi: a "crystal clear content in a very clean setting. I am aware of only a couple of examples of 4-phases Burmistrov Combination, that, however, exploit totally different mechanisms. Here the strategy underlying the King's Le Grand is of striking consistency across all phases, exploiting the release of control by the keys of squares f5, f4, e6 and d6 respectively in the extended field of the black King to reduce to the unit the 4 set mates after kings' flight. All four thematic mates are battery mates by wQ-wR battery,.

1...Ke5 x 2.Tc4 A, R:e3 B, Rd3 C, R:c5# D; 1.B:f7? [2.Rc4 A, R:e3 B,

Rd3# C] Ke5 x 2.R:c5#D, but 1...Qd5!; 1.Bf8? [2.R:c5# D] Ke5 x 2.Rc4# A, but 1...Ne7!; 1.Nb7? [2.R:c5# D] Ke5 x 2.R:e3 B, but 1...Ne4!; **key 1.Kb6!** [2.R:c5 D] Ke5 x 2.Rd3# C, 1...Ne4/b:c3/R:c2/c4 2.N:c6/Q:c3/R:c2/Rd3#

Luis Gomez Palazon

2nd HM, FIDE World Cup 2025



Mate in two moves

A nice, classical Zagoruiko 3x2 in a light setting, with an option play by the white Queen to reach e3. 1.Qxf3? [2.Qe3#] e:d5 a 2.Q:d5# A, 1...Q:c4 b 2.R:c4# B, but 1...Q:c6! c 1.Dc1? [2.De3#] e:d5 a 2.c:b5# C, 1...Q:c4 b 2.Q:c4 # D, 1...Q:c6 c 2 Qa3# G, but 1...d2! **1.Qe1!** [2.Qe3] e:d5 a 2.Q:e7# E, 1...Q:c4 b 2.N:e7# F, 1...Q:c6 c

A problem for solving

Anatoly Vasylenko

3 prize, FIDE World Cup 2025



Mate in two moves

Solutions to H#2 in the article' Theme for helpmates':-1.Re1 Qxe4 2.Kd1 Qd3; 1.Bc2 Qxh1 2.Kd3 Qf1; 1.Qg2 Qxb3 2.Kf1 Qd1

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